

We rarely have to carry cash, if ever. Buy your gas by paying at the pump with a card. Forgot your checkbook and you want to buy fruit at the market? No problem. All major credit cards are accepted now. And McDonald's? They'll let you swipe your card for an eighty-six cent soft drink. Kids' toys today may or may not come with play money, but the pretend grocery store has a price scanner and credit card swipe machine. Credit may not be the way of the world, but it is the way of America. We are a convenience-oriented society, and credit cards are convenient. It is very fitting that our government, the IRS, allows people the "convenience" of paying their taxes with their credit cards today.

The credit card companies bombard us with advertisements, offers, and competitive terms. We can personalize our cards with our favorite charity logo, a scenic picture, or if we so desire, our baby's first birthday smile can be emblazoned on our plastic of choice. And if we have a standard issue card, we can now buy a "credit cover" to dress it up and make it reflect our personality, just like we can buy a funky cover for our cell phone or iPod. A young entrepreneur has started a company selling "skins" for credit cards for five bucks a pop, and business is booming. So when you tire of a certain design, for another five dollars, you can spruce up the wardrobe of your constant companion. And how do you pay that five dollars? With your credit card, of course.

The consumer lending industry desires that credit purchases be easy in order to eventually become a habit. They want you to make that first purchase, and then they start cranking the reel, drawing you in with the hook attached to your wallet. The aggressive practices of the credit card companies, the banks, and the lenders take advantage of the American public. It's the greatest rip-off of American citizens in our nation's history. They rip us off and then they turn up their noses and say credit card customers need to be more "responsible." Let's see who the conscientious party is in the credit card world.

Piling It On

The tactics that the banks and credit card companies use affect every single person in America, regardless of your income or education. What you don't know does hurt you. The credit card companies can steal you blind, and the government lets them.